ГУДЕН ДАХ.

West Flemish, written in Cyrillic.

An alphabet for a dialect that never had one.
Learn it, teach it, say it out loud.



≈ 1 in 1,000,000 can read this. Be one.

CYRILLIC × WEST-VLAAMS × PHONETICS

Воор Україне.

Voor Oekraïne: why this alphabet, and not another.

1 **The sound**

Ukrainian **Г** is a voiced h, exactly the West Flemish g. Its **е**, **и** and **і** match our e, short i and ie. Few alphabets fit our dialect this well.

2 **Solidarity**

West Flanders knows what it means to be invaded and to have your language pushed aside. So does Ukraine.

West-Vlaanderen	Україна
1302 The French king's army marches on Flanders. Militias with goedendags stop it at Kortrijk.	**1863 · 1876** The Russian Empire restricts, then bans most printing in Ukrainian.
1914–1918 The front runs through the Westhoek. Ypres is shot to ruins.	**Soviet era** Russian is pushed as the language of school and career.
19th–20th century French schools push Flemish out of French Flanders. In Belgium, Dutch speakers fight for equal rights.	**Since 2022** A full-scale invasion, and a fight to keep the country and its language.

Writing our dialect in their letters is a small gesture: two peoples who kept talking in their own language, side by side.

Де леттерс

25 letters, in three groups. Learn the red ones first.

The liars look Latin, sound different

В	Н	Р	С	Х	У	Е
w / v	n	r	s	ch	oe	e

Г	И
g (soft)	i (short)

The honest ones same as Latin

А	К	М	О	Т	І
a	k	m	o	t	ie

The new faces nothing like Latin

Д	Л	П	Б	З	Ф	Й
d	l	p	b	z	f	j

Я	Є	Ю
ja	je	u / ui

Read Greek? You already know half of these. Cyrillic was built from Greek.

Δ → Д (d) · Λ → Л (l) · Π → П (p) · Р → Р (r) · Х → Х (ch) · Г → Г (g) · Ф → Ф (f)

Trap № 1: **И** looks like a backwards N, but it is the short **i** of *ik*. The n is **Н**, which looks like an H.

Схріф ват ге оорт.

Schrief wat ge oort: write what you hear, not how Dutch spells it.

FLEMISH SOUND	WRITE	EXAMPLE
g the soft West Flemish g	**г**	goed → **гут**
g at the end or before t hardens into the throat sound	**х**	krachtig → **крахтех** · zegt → **зехт**
ch	**х**	wacht → **вахт**
sch	**сх**	schoon → **схоон**
h dropped, as in speech	**—**	hij → **і** · helemaal → **еелемаал**
ie · ij · ei	**і**	gie → **гі** · nie → **ні**
short i as in ik	**и**	schild → **схилт**
e · weak e	**е**	letters → **леттерс**
oe	**у**	moet → **мут**
u · ui	**ю**	gulden → **гюлден** · nu → **ню**
j · ja · je	**й я є**	ja → **я**
w · v	**в**	waarom → **ваарром** · voor → **воор**
long vowel write it twice	**аа ее**	weet → **веет**
d at the end sounds like t	**т**	vriend → **врінт**
't · het	**ет**	't werkt → **ет веркт**
c (as s) · z · f	**с з ф**	cijfers → **сіферс** · zo → **зо**

Rule zero: spelling is free. Read it aloud.

іепер or **інер**, **коффіе** or **коффі**: if it sounds right, it is right. The rules above are a guide, not a law.

Ет тутсенборт

Ukrainian layout. The small letter is the English key in the same spot.



the liars · used in the code · not needed

Add it to your phone

1. **iPhone:** Settings → General → Keyboard → Keyboards → Add New → Ukrainian
2. Tap the globe key to switch.

1. **Android (Gboard):** keyboard settings → Languages → Add keyboard → Ukrainian
2. Tap the globe key or hold the space bar.

Muscle memory the five you type most

к R	а F	т N	н Y	е T

So **кат** = R · F · N and **нее** = Y · T · T. Look at the letter on the key, not the English spot.

Ет воорденбук

Everything we've used so far. Read the Cyrillic column out loud.

CODE	WEST-VLAAMS	ENGLISH
BASICS		
гуйендах	*goeiendag*	hello
я / нее	*ja / nee*	yes / no
гі · і	*gie · ie*	you · he
гут	*goed*	good
ваарром?	*waarom?*	why?
крахтех	*krachtig*	powerful
схоон	*schoon*	beautiful
SENTENCES		
ет веркт!	*et werkt!*	it works!
гін проблеем	*gin probleem*	no problem
пакт у тіт	*pakt oe tied*	take your time
к вахт нох	*'k wacht nog*	I'm still waiting
гі ет гелік	*gie et geliek*	you're right
мо ні еелемаал	*mo nie eelemaal*	but not entirely
і веет ет ні, зехт і	*ie weet et nie, zegt ie*	he doesn't know, he says
дан ес ет е гуйе коде	*dan es et e goeie code*	then it's a good code
тот зо!	*tot zo!*	see you soon!

Зех ет ют лют!

Zeg et uut luud: say it out loud. That's how this alphabet is learned and taught.

1 **Learn the nine liars first.**
В Н Р С Х У Е Г И look Latin but aren't. They cause most mistakes.

2 **Read everything out loud.**
Spelling is free. If it sounds right, it is right.

3 **One word a day.**
Type it on the Ukrainian keyboard, say it, send it to someone.

4 **Teach by voice.**
Say a word, let the learner write it in Cyrillic, then swap roles.

5 **Use words from home.**
Ypres–Kortrijk words that nobody else knows are exactly what this alphabet is for. Write them down before they disappear.

TEST · DECODE THIS

гі веет ет ні, мо ет веркт!

Answer

Gie weet et nie, mo et werkt! (You don't know it, but it works!)

ТОТ ЗО!

ЛЕЕРВЕРСІ № 001
ОКТОБЕР 2026
VRIJ TE DELEN · FREE TO SHARE